

*Early-morning deep synthesis. Assembles the already-baked projection bundle with the league scouting boards — nothing is recomputed. Companion to the gameday one-pager; this is the scouting-and-reasoning layer.*

### Fair-value readout (audit, not a directional call)

- **Fair spread:** DAL by 9.9 (model home-margin +9.9).
- **Fair projected score:** POR 79.0 — DAL 90.0.
- **Fair total:** 169.0.
- **Rest:** DAL 2d / POR 2d — even rest.
- *These are the platform's own fair lines — an audit of the model, not a directional call. No market price is quoted or implied.*

### POR — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** no qualified rim protector projects onto the floor (1 graded on a sub-40-shot sample — too thin to rank) — DAL's at-rim scorers face a soft interior.
- **Elite finisher:** Karlie Samuelson (+12.1 PAX/100 overall).

### POR — rotation reasoning

- **Out (3):** Sania Feagin, Luisa Geiselsoder, Sarah Ashlee Barker — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Bridget Carleton (33), Carla Leite (28), Emily Engstler (25), Nyadiew Puoch (25), Karlie Samuelson (18).

### DAL — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** no qualified rim protector projects onto the floor — POR's at-rim scorers face a soft interior.
- **Elite finisher:** Paige Bueckers (+12.9 PAX/100 overall).

### DAL — rotation reasoning

- **Out (3):** Aziaha James, Azzi Fudd, Costanza Verona — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Paige Bueckers (32), Arike Ogunbowale (32), Jessica Shepard (28), Alanna Smith (24), Awak Kuier (22).

### Matchup implication

- **POR at the rim:** DAL projects no qualified rim protector on the floor — POR's interior scorers face a soft rim (last-season grades).
- **DAL at the rim:** POR projects no qualified rim protector on the floor — DAL's interior scorers face a soft rim (last-season grades).

*Deep scouting report — assembled 2026-08-25T11:18:26Z from the morning projection bundle and the league scouting boards. Nothing here is recomputed; every number traces back to the report of record for this date.*